BrightTime

DOCUMENTATION

Guide for Organisations

Listings, registration, attendance, messages and reports in the console

For owners, admins and staff of organisations that run activities

BrightTime is a countywide platform for out-of-school time. Families and young people find after-school, summer and weekend activities; the organisations that run them take registrations and record attendance; and the county's network organisers vet every organisation and listing.

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CHAPTER 1

BrightTime for organisations

This guide is for the people who run activities: an organisation's owners, admins and staff. Most of it happens in the **console** on the website. Taking attendance on a phone happens in the app.

Joining BrightTime

1. Open **List your organisation** (`/providers/apply`) and fill in three short sections: **You**, **Your organisation**, and **Where you run activities** (your main site; add more later).
2. We email you. If the address is new to BrightTime, the email has a link to choose a password. If you were signed in when you applied, you're the organisation's **owner**.
3. A **network organiser** reviews the application, usually within a few working days. They check your contact details, your website, your safeguarding policy and, where needed, your insurance. They may ask for changes: the console then shows what they asked for, and **Send back for review** on your **Profile** returns it to them once you've made the changes.
4. **Meanwhile you can draft listings.** They're published once you're approved.

If someone invites you to join an organisation, the invitation appears under **Invitations** when you sign in. **Accept** or **Decline** it there.

Sign in, then open **Your organisations** to reach the console. Each organisation has its own set of tabs: **Listings, Profile, Sites, Staff, Import, Forms, Applications, Attendance, Fees and payments, Messages** and **Reports**. You see only the tabs your role allows.

Who can do what

Each person has one role in each organisation.

	Owner, admin	Staff
Draft, edit, submit, preview and copy listings	•	•
Add and edit sites	•	•
See and decide applications, offer places from the waitlist	•	•
Take attendance and correct it	•	•
Message families, send announcements	•	•
Download reports	•	•
Edit the organisation's profile	•	
Invite staff, change roles, remove people	•	
Import listings	•	
Write forms, waivers and eligibility rules	•	
Set an activity's places	•	
Set fees, waive a fee, mark a payment received	•	

An organisation can also give someone the **mentor** or **viewer** role. Neither can use the applications, attendance, messages, payments or reports pages.

Your organisation: profile, sites and staff

Profile. Your **name** (the one families know), **type of organisation**, **what you do** (a few sentences for your public page), **website**, **public email** and **phone**, and the **languages your staff speak**. Your **legal name** is seen only by network organisers. If two people edit the profile at once, the second save is refused rather than overwriting the first: reload and make your changes again.

Sites are the places where you run activities. For each site:

- its **name** (imports match sites by name), **street address**, **town** and **ZIP code**;
- its **neighbourhood**, which places it on the map and in distance search;
- **Show the street address publicly**: untick it for a private home or a shelter, and families see only the neighbourhood;
- **opening hours**, by day and season;
- **access**: wheelchair access, an elevator, an accessible restroom, a quiet space, finding the entrance, parking, and getting there by bus or train.

Until street-level locations are available, the map places a site at the centre of its neighbourhood. **Close the site** keeps it on record but stops listings showing it; **Reopen the site** brings it back.

Staff. Invite someone by email with a role and an optional job title. They get a link (and choose a password first if they're new), then accept the invitation after signing in. Under **Manage** you can change someone's role, choose which sites they work at, remove them, or withdraw an invitation that hasn't been accepted.

Each person's **clearances** (background check, child abuse registry, fingerprinting, CPR and first aid, safeguarding and mandated reporter training, and so on) show only their status and expiry date. Reports from those checks are never kept on BrightTime.

Listings

The **Listings** tab groups your listings by state: **drafts**, **waiting for review**, **changes requested**, **published**, **unpublished**, **rejected** and **archived**.

Writing a listing. The editor has these sections:

Section	What goes in it
Basics	Title (short and plain: what it is, not who runs it), a one-sentence summary for search results, the description (plain text, a blank line between paragraphs), the kind (program, event, drop-in resource, or job or internship) and the language it's written in
Audience	Youngest and oldest age; lowest and highest grade (-1 for pre-K, 0 for kindergarten)
When	One date or every week (or every few weeks); first and last date; start and end time; days of the week; days with no session, such as holidays
Where	In person, online or both; which of your sites; the link to join online
Cost	Free, a fixed price, a sliding scale (lowest and highest price, and how it works), it varies, or participants are paid (jobs)
Registration	Through BrightTime, on your own website (with the link), or no registration (drop in); whether families can drop in without booking; places available; a deadline
Topics	The categories, interests and skills families filter by
Access and support	Meals provided, transport provided and getting there, languages spoken, anything else about access
Contact for families	An email and phone number
When it shows	**Show from** a date (empty means as soon as it's approved) and **take down after** a date

Preview as families will see it shows the finished page and the next sessions, before anyone else sees it.

Getting it published.

1. **Save draft** as often as you like.

2. **Save and submit**. A network organiser reviews it and either publishes it, asks for changes (with a note you'll see on the listing) or rejects it.
3. To change a listing that's waiting for review, **withdraw it from review** first.
4. Your organisation must be approved before any listing can be published.

Changing a published listing. Your edits go live at once, and a network organiser looks at the change afterwards. **Take it off the site** (unpublish) asks you why; the organiser sees your reason.

Copy for a new season makes a new draft with the same details. Choose the first session of the new season: everything else moves by the same number of days, and a weekly session moves to the next matching day. Give the copy a season name such as *Summer 2027*, check it, and submit it.

Importing listings

Owners and admins can bring in many listings at once from **Import**.

1. Choose the format: a **CSV** spreadsheet (download the **CSV template**, which lists every column with an example row) or **HSDS 3.0 JSON** (Open Referral).
2. Upload the file. BrightTime checks every row first and shows **what the import would do** for each: a **new draft**, an **update**, **left alone** (waiting for review or no longer editable), or **not imported** with the error.
3. **Apply the import.** Rows with errors are skipped. New listings are drafts you submit as usual. Updates to published listings go live at once, and an organiser looks at them again.

Importing the same file twice doesn't create duplicates: rows are matched by your own id for each listing. The column-by-column reference is in docs/import.md.

Registration: forms, eligibility and waivers

These apply to listings that register **through BrightTime**. Families can't apply through the website or the app yet; when they can, these are what they'll see. You can set them up now.

Forms (owners and admins) are the questions families answer when they apply.

1. **Start a new form** with a name and its first question.
2. **Add a question**: the question in English, its kind (short text, long text, number, date, yes or no, one choice, several choices, or an agreement to tick), whether it's **required**, help text, limits, the choices, and the question in other languages.
3. Mark a question **sensitive** if its answer must never be used in reports, exports or ranking.
4. **Publish.** A published version never changes, and each application keeps the version it answered. To change it, **make the next version**, which starts as a draft.
5. **Use this form** for a listing. A listing asks for one form; choosing another replaces it. **Retire** stops any listing starting to use a version.

Eligibility (owners and admins) says who can apply to an activity. Families see these rules before they apply.

- Rules are by **age** (taken on a date you choose, usually the first day), **school grade**, or **where they live** (chosen neighbourhoods).
- Each rule either **must be met**, which makes an applicant ineligible when it isn't, or is **advice only**, which is shown but changes nothing.
- **Try the rules** against a made-up applicant to see what they'd say. Nothing is saved.

Waivers (owners and admins) are statements families sign, such as a photo release.

- Write the text (bold, lists and links are allowed), then **publish** it. Families sign the exact text of a published version, so it never changes. **Make the next version** to change it.
- **Ask families to sign** it on a listing, as **required** or **optional**. An application can't be submitted until every required waiver is signed.
- A parent or guardian signs for anyone under 18.
- The page counts signatures without showing anyone's.

Applications, places and the waitlist

Applications lists the activities taking applications; choose one to see its queue. Each row shows the applicant (as the family shares them, or *Name not shared*), when they applied, whether they're eligible, the status, and their waitlist place.

Places. An owner or admin sets an activity's **places**, and optionally its **waitlist places**. Nobody can be accepted until an activity has places. The page shows how many are taken and how many are waiting.

Deciding. Open an application to see what the family shares, each eligibility rule (met, not met, or can't tell yet), and the answers (sensitive ones are marked). Then **accept**, **put on the waitlist**, **decline**, or **mark as being reviewed**, with an optional note. To decide many at once, tick them in the queue and **apply to selected**. The page tells you which it left as they were, and why. The last place always goes to exactly one applicant, even if two people accept at the same moment.

The waitlist. When places free up, staff **offer places** to the front of the waitlist. Each family offered a place takes it or declines; an offer they don't answer expires.

From an application you can also **Message the family**.

Fees and payments

Owners and admins manage these under **Fees and payments**.

Fees. For each activity, add one or more fees: a name, an amount, how often (once, each session, week, month or season), and which is the **default**. An activity with no fees is free.

Price levels lower a fee for households that fit them: by household size, by an income band such as *under_35k*, or both, with the wording families see. Families pick the level they fit. Nobody is asked their income, and none is kept.

Payments. Each activity's **Payments** page shows who owes what, how they're paying (**online** or **in person**) and the status. You can:

- **Mark received**, with an optional note, for a payment made in person;
- **Waive** a fee, with a reason.

Card details never pass through BrightTime: online payments are made on the payment service's own page. Where your county hasn't set up online payments, every payment is in person.

Attendance

In the console. Attendance shows a week of your meetings; move between weeks with **previous** and **next**. Open a meeting's **roster**:

- Mark each young person **present**, **late**, **left early**, **absent** or **excused**, then **save attendance** for the whole roster at once. You can mark from an hour before the meeting starts.
- To change a mark already saved, say **why**. The reason is kept with the change, and **corrected marks** lists every change.
- If some marks couldn't be saved, the reason is shown next to each name; the rest were saved.

On a phone, without a signal. In the app, open **Attendance**:

1. The first time, **Set up phone**: give the phone a name. It's then registered to send attendance for your organisation.
2. **Take roster** for one of today's meetings while you have a signal.
3. Mark it anywhere, signal or not. Marks are kept sealed on the phone.
4. **Send now** when you're back online. Each mark is sent once, however many times you press it. If someone else marked a person first, the app says so.

For safety, a phone that hasn't been online for 72 hours locks the roster until it reconnects. If a phone is lost and its access withdrawn, it deletes everything it held the next time it connects.

Families can also **check in** with a code on their phone that staff scan, or by scanning a code a kiosk shows. The codes are built; the scanning and kiosk screens are still to come.

Messages

Messages lists the conversations you're in with families.

- **Start one** from an application or a roster row (**Message the family**), with an optional subject.

- **No adult is ever alone in a conversation with a young person.** If a young person is in it, an admin of your organisation joins and reads along, and everyone in it is told so. If no admin can, BrightTime refuses to start it.
- A message an adult sends to a young person may be **held for a moderator** if it looks like an attempt to swap contact details. Only you see it, marked as held.
- **Announce to an activity's families** sends one message to every family with a child enrolled. Families don't reply and never see each other. A young person gets it only with consent and an admin reading along; the page tells you how many were left out.

Reports

Reports makes a file when you download it, as **PDF**, **Excel** or **CSV**. Nothing is kept on BrightTime afterwards.

Report	What's in it
Roster	Everyone enrolled in an activity now, when they enrolled, and how many meetings they've attended
Attendance	An activity's attendance, each young person against each meeting, for a period
Participation	Counts across your activities, safe to share with a funder: small numbers are hidden, and the report says what it hid

A name appears only where the family shares it with your organisation. Keep downloaded copies safe: some name young people.

Badges

Your organisation can award **digital badges** to the young people in your programs, in the Open Badges standard, so they can show them anywhere that reads badges. The badges are built, and their console screens are next. When they arrive:

- Owners and admins **define** a badge: its name, a description, the **criteria** (what someone did to earn it), and optionally how many months it lasts. It's a draft until it's **published**; after that it never changes. **Retire** stops it being awarded; badges already awarded stand.
- Staff **award** a published badge to a young person enrolled with you, with an optional note about what they did. Each young person holds a badge once.
- Owners and admins can **revoke** an award, saying why. Anyone checking the badge sees at once that it was revoked, and the reason.
- Your organisation is the badge's issuer, under its own digital identity, so a badge says who vouched for it.

Playlists

A **playlist** is a set of steps young people work through at their own pace, with one of your badges at the end. Playlists are built behind the scenes too, and their console screens are next. When they arrive:

- Staff write a playlist as a draft: a title, a description, whether the steps go in order, an age range and estimated hours, the badge it awards, and optionally a badge someone must already hold to start it.
- Each step is one of: **attend a listing** (done once their attendance is recorded), **an activity elsewhere** (a link), **a reflection** they write, or **a check-in with staff**. Any step can be marked for review, and a check-in always is. Steps are required unless you say otherwise.
- **Publish** it, and from then on it never changes, because everyone's progress refers to its steps. **Archive** stops anyone new starting; those already on it carry on.
- Staff **review** submitted steps: approve one, or send it back with a note saying what to do again. You see each young person only by the display name they chose for their portfolio.
- When someone finishes every required step, they're given the playlist's badge, signed by your organisation.

Gating a program on a badge. An activity's eligibility can now require a badge, or a completed playlist, as a rule that must be met. A young person who doesn't hold it can't submit an application. For now these two rules are set through the API; the console's eligibility page shows them but doesn't add them yet.

What you can see about families, and why

- **Only what each family shares with you.** A family chooses which members and which details your organisation sees, for one program or all of them, and until a date. Where a family hasn't shared a name, you see *Name not shared*.
- **Only while the share lasts.** If a family withdraws it, those details disappear from your screens and reports at once.
- **Every look is recorded.** Opening an application, a roster or a report that names a young person is written to an audit log that can't be edited.
- **Sensitive answers** are never used in reports or exports.
- **No home addresses** for young people, anywhere.

CHAPTER 2

About BrightTime

BrightTime helps a county's families and young people find things to do outside school, and helps the organisations that run those activities manage them. Each guide below is written for one kind of person.

If you are…	Read
A parent or guardian	Families
13 or over, with your own account	Young people
Someone who runs activities for an organisation	Organisations
A network organiser for the county	Network organisers

One person can be more than one of these. A parent who also coaches a team uses both the families and the organisations guide, with the same account.

Where BrightTime runs

- **The website**, on the county's own address (for the seed region, `kettle.localhost` in development). Anyone can search it without an account, and it works with JavaScript turned off, on a slow connection or an old phone. Organisations and network organisers use its **console**: the pages under *Your organisations*, *Review queue* and the other links that appear once you sign in.
- **The app**, for Android and iOS. It searches the same listings and adds what a phone does well: a personal feed, reminders, notifications, a family's consent centre, and taking attendance without a signal.

Languages

Everything is offered in English, Spanish, Chinese (Simplified), Bengali, Haitian Creole and Arabic. Choose a language at the foot of any web page, or under **Account** in the app. Arabic reads right to left throughout.

The translations are machine drafts until native speakers have reviewed them. A listing that was translated by machine says so.

What is ready, and what is coming

BrightTime is being built in stages. This table says where each part stands today, so that nothing in these guides promises a screen that doesn't exist yet.

	Website	App	Notes
Searching and browsing activities	Yes	Yes	
Saving activities	Yes (this browser only)	Yes (follows your account)	
Accounts, passwords, passkeys	Yes	Yes	
Children's profiles and consent	The consent email's link	Yes	
Agreeing to the terms of use	Yes	Yes	
A personal feed, interests, your area, reminders, notifications		Yes	
Organisations: profile, sites, staff, listings, import	Yes		
Organisations: forms, eligibility, waivers, applications, fees, attendance, messages, reports	Yes		
Organisations: taking attendance on a phone, offline		Yes	
Network organisers: review, taxonomy, wording, audit	Yes		
Families applying to programs, signing waivers and paying	Coming	Coming	Built behind the scenes; the family screens are next
A household's family profile and sharing it with an organisation	Coming	Coming	As above
Messages from organisations, and a family's own attendance	Coming	Coming	As above
A young person's portfolio, badges and playlists	Coming	Coming	As above
Organisations: playlists	Coming		As above
Organisations: badges	Coming		As above

Where a listing says "*Registration through BrightTime opens soon*", contact the organisation named on it to save a place for now.

Words used in these guides

- **Listing** or **activity**: one thing to do: a program, an event, a drop-in resource, or a job or internship.
- **Organisation**: a group that runs activities. Families sometimes call them providers.
- **Site**: a place where an organisation runs activities.
- **Network organiser**: the county's own staff, who check every organisation and listing before it goes live.
- **Consent**: a parent's or guardian's agreement, given one thing at a time, for a child under 13 to use part of BrightTime.
- **Share**: what a family chooses to let one organisation see about its members, and for how long.